

Peach Disease Management

Covers: Bacterial Spot, Healthy

Compiled from public university cooperative extension publications for testing InsightAI-RAG's retrieval and grounding quality against real agricultural guidance. This is not a substitute for consulting a local agronomist or extension office before applying any treatment. Always follow current product labels; pesticide registrations change and vary by region.

Bacterial Spot — *Xanthomonas arboricola* pv. *pruni* (syn. *X. pruni*)

Affects peaches, nectarines, apricots, plums, prunes and cherries; widespread east of the Rockies. On leaves, small (1/25-1/5 inch) irregular-to-angular deep purple to rusty-brown/black spots form; centers dry and tear away leaving ragged 'shot-holes'. Merged spots make leaves appear scorched or blighted, and badly infected leaves yellow and drop early — most common on nitrogen-deficient trees (care must be taken not to misdiagnose this as nitrogen deficiency alone: bacterial spot symptoms concentrate at the leaf tip, nitrogen deficiency along the midrib). On fruit, small round olive-brown-to-black spots form, usually sunken with a water-soaked margin, concentrated on the sun-exposed side; spots may enlarge, merge, exude yellowish gum, and cause skin cracking. Twig cankers occur in two forms: 'spring cankers' on the previous year's young twigs (water-soaked blisters near first-leaf emergence, which release bacteria as they rupture) and 'summer cankers' on current-season green twigs. Warm temperatures (70-85F) with light rain, heavy dew, and wind favor spread; the disease makes little progress in hot, dry weather. Severe infection can force discarding 50%+ of fruit on susceptible varieties and can weaken trees enough to predispose them to winter injury.

Management: Site new orchards away from low-lying or shaded, poorly-drained areas; anything that speeds fruit/foilage drying reduces infection risk. Destroy nearby wild or neglected stone fruit trees, and buy only vigorous, disease-free nursery stock. Prune annually for airflow and vigor, ideally during dry weather in late dormancy. Select resistant varieties where available (e.g. Belle of Georgia, Biscoe, Candor, Redhaven, Redskin are noted as somewhat resistant; Elberta, Jerseyland and J.H. Hale are noted as very susceptible). Fertilize to maintain vigor without excessive shoot growth. No spray program fully controls this disease, and home-orchard spraying generally isn't considered practical; commercial growers should consult a current regional spray guide.

Source: The Ohio State University Extension, Ohioline PLPATH-FRU-38 'Bacterial Spot of Stone Fruits' (2016)

Healthy

No signs of disease detected. Maintain tree vigor through proper fertilization and pruning, and monitor closely during warm, wet spring weather when bacterial spot spreads fastest.

Source: General extension guidance